

Marriott accelerates AI and cloud transformation as Q1 2026 RevPAR rises 6.2 percent

06/05/2026

Marriott International is accelerating a large-scale technology transformation strategy centered on **artificial intelligence**, cloud migration, and digital personalization as the hospitality giant strengthens direct customer engagement and operational efficiency across its global portfolio of nearly 1.6 million rooms.



Marriott digital plans 2025

During the Q1 2026 earnings call, CEO Anthony Capuano highlighted that technology modernization is becoming foundational to Marriott's long-term growth strategy. The company is embedding AI across customer engagement, revenue management, and hotel operations to improve guest experience while driving profitability.

Naveen Manga is the Global Chief Technology Officer of Marriott International, overseeing technology strategy, innovation, and digital transformation for the company's 8,700+ hotels.

Marriott is targeting Investment spending of \$1.050 billion to \$1.150 billion in 2026. Investment spending includes capital and technology expenditures, loan advances, contract acquisition costs, and other investing activities.



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Marriott's AI-driven personalization platform is leveraging data from its 210 million Bonvoy members to deliver customized travel recommendations, targeted promotions, and “next best action” offers. The centralized data platform is helping Marriott create hyper-personalized experiences across its global hotel network, luxury brands, and travel services ecosystem.

Artificial intelligence is also playing a major role in revenue optimization. Marriott said advanced AI pricing algorithms are dynamically adjusting room rates and inventory in real time, contributing to a 6.2 percent increase in global RevPAR during Q1 2026. The company is also using operational AI tools to improve labor scheduling and supply chain logistics, helping hotel operators manage inflationary pressures and protect margins.

A pillar of Marriott's digital transformation strategy is “Project Catalyst,” a multi-year modernization initiative focused on replacing legacy reservation and property management systems with cloud-native infrastructure. Marriott is aggressively migrating core technology systems to the cloud to improve scalability, system reliability, and deployment speed for new services across international markets.

The rollout of Marriott's cloud-based reservation platform is enabling more sophisticated “attribute-based selling,” allowing customers to reserve highly customized room experiences such as preferred views, floor levels, or room layouts. The modernization effort is supported by significant technology capital expenditures aimed at supporting Marriott's expanding global footprint.

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Marriott reported net room growth of 4.5 percent, bringing its system to nearly 1.6 million rooms. The scale of this expansion is increasing demand for high-performance cloud infrastructure and centralized digital operations management.

The Marriott Bonvoy mobile app remains central to Marriott's direct-to-consumer strategy. Digital channels accounted for a record share of total bookings in Q1 2026, reducing dependence on higher-cost third-party booking intermediaries. Marriott also reported a double-digit increase in active mobile app users compared with the previous year.

Growth in app engagement has been driven by features including digital check-in, mobile room key access, and real-time messaging with hotel staff. Marriott is also expanding the Bonvoy ecosystem beyond hotel bookings into luxury home rentals

and cruise offerings integrated within the same digital platform.



Regional performance also reflected the strength of Marriott's digital expansion strategy. Asia Pacific excluding China delivered an 18 percent surge in RevPAR as technology-enabled cross-border travel demand accelerated. Marriott's luxury portfolio, including brands such as The Ritz-Carlton Hotel Company and St. Regis Hotels & Resorts, also recorded strong demand supported by personalized digital concierge services and premium guest engagement tools.

Marriott generated net income of \$720 million during Q1 2026, supported in part by technology-led operational efficiencies and stronger direct digital bookings. The company also emphasized continued investments in cybersecurity, data privacy, and infrastructure protection as its digital footprint and customer database continue to expand globally.

Marriott believes that embedding AI across the entire guest journey, combined with cloud-native infrastructure and a rapidly growing digital ecosystem, will increase customer lifetime value while reinforcing its position as the world's largest lodging company.

RAJANI BABURAJAN

